

Reminder ask — verification round two

Re-walkthrough after PR #1607, joshing-11.vercel.app

2026-09-06 · Duo Prova (+1 555-222-2222, inviter) → Quinn Prova (+1 555-333-3333, fresh signup) · Verifies #1604, #1605, #1607 · Produced #1608

Re-ran the full invite → signup → onboarding → reminder-ask flow against production to confirm the three fixes from #1607. Two of the three hold. The third does not — and the walkthrough is the only reason we know.

HEADLINE · THE FIX DID NOT WORK

The confirmation toast still never reaches the player. #1607 moved it out of a conditional render so it would always mount — and it does. But it renders at --z-toast (70), underneath the fullscreen crafting screen's --z-takeover (80). On a slow build it sits invisible behind the loader while its own 1.8s dismiss timer runs, and has already expired by the time the loader clears. The first fix traded a conditional-render bug for a z-index one; the player saw nothing either way. Fixed in **#1608** by gating on !loading, so the toast starts its life when there is something to show it over.

WHAT ROUND TWO CONFIRMED

BEHAVIOR	RESULT
Invite-link rows read "Swap", not a bare ×	✓ Live and correct
At-cap helper: "All 3 topics are taken. Tap Swap above..."	✓ Live — previously blank space
"No category — carries all 3 topics above"	✓ Live, accurate count
SMS opt-in completes end-to-end with a test number	✓ Confirmed — the path that was untestable before
Opt-in retires both later prompts in one write	✓ Confirmed via DB
No real Twilio send fires for an allowlisted number	✓ Confirmed — no log row written
Confirmation toast visible to the player	✗ Failed — covered by the crafting screen

STEPS

1. Logged in as **Duo Prova**; opened the invite-link panel and confirmed all three invite-link fixes render as intended.
2. Logged out, opened the existing /u/duoprova/... link, and signed up **+1 555-333-3333** as a genuinely fresh account (the prior test account had been deleted, freeing the number).
3. OTP bypass carried the signup with no real text sent. Profile saved as **Quinn Prova**.
4. Onboarding arrived with all three topics as unselected suggestions, including Final Fantasy. Selected all three.

5. Reached the reminder ask and tapped **Text me when they open** — the exact action that failed in round one.
6. **It succeeded.** No error, straight through to /daily, and this time generation was slow enough that the crafting screen genuinely appeared ("Crafting your bespoke questions").
7. Watched for the confirmation toast through the crafting screen and past it into the first question. It never appeared.
8. Reproduced deliberately via /daily?remindersOn=1 and watched the loader clear with no toast behind it — confirming the z-index/timer interaction rather than a one-off miss.
9. Verified consent and suppression state directly in the database, and confirmed no confirmation SMS was logged.

EVIDENCE

The opt-in write, which round one could never reach:

```
sms_opt_in opted_in
sms_opt_in_at 2026-09-06 00:13:39.152+00
sms_consent_source onboarding_web_form
sms_consent_policy_version 2026-09-02
reminder_prompt_dismissed_at 2026-09-06 00:13:39.349+00
reminder_interstitial_seen_at 2026-09-06 00:13:39.349+00
```

Every SMS ever logged for that number — both from round one's failed real sends, none from today's opt-in:

```
otp 2026-09-05 23:25:47+00
otp 2026-09-05 23:25:06+00
```

WHAT THIS SAYS ABOUT THE PROCESS

THE WALKTHROUGH EARNED ITS KEEP

#1607 passed typecheck, lint, 96 tests and five style ratchets. None of that could catch a toast painted underneath a takeover layer — it takes a human-shaped pass through the real screen, at real timing, on real infrastructure.

The same is true of round one, which found the original bug. Two rounds, two defects, neither visible to the test suite.

A FIX IS A HYPOTHESIS UNTIL IT IS WATCHED

The first fix was reasoned from the right diagnosis and still failed, because it moved the element into a layer nobody checked. Worth treating "verified by re-walkthrough" as the bar for anything whose whole purpose is to be seen.

STILL OPEN · CARRIED FROM ROUND ONE

Generation timing remains unmeasured at any real sample size — round one saw a fast build, round two a slow one, from an instrumentation table that had one usable row. It decides how often the crafting screen appears at all, so it is worth letting `DailyBuildMetric` accumulate before tuning anything around the wait.